

ICQ 7.1

ICQ (I – Seek – You) was the pioneer of Instant Messaging Services on the web way back in 1996 and is still going strong with more than 42 million users and roughly a billion messages being exchanged every day. The new ICQ 7 (followed quickly by ICQ 7.1) is packed with a whole lot of features that just might make you want to switch over from your favourite Chat Client. Here's how.

Get started

You can download ICQ 7 from www.tinyurl.com/digit-icq. Once you've gone through the motions of setting it up, you'll find an eye-pleasing window asking you to sign in.



icq 7

Try this or ICQ Lite

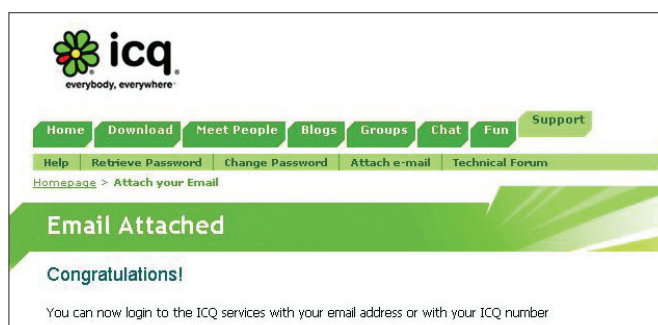
Since you're probably a first time user, you'll have to click on the 'New? Register Here' link under the 'Accounts' tab.

When you register, be sure to fill in a valid email id because

Complete the formalities



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This message proves you're in

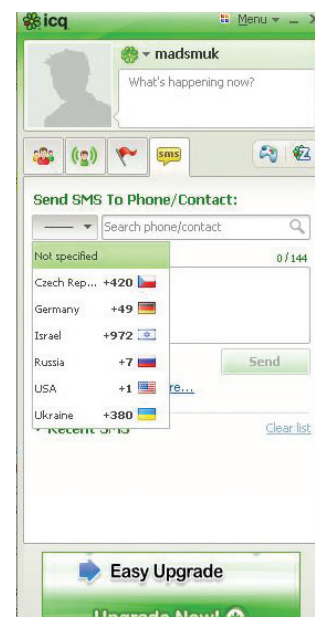
the activation link will be sent to that address. There are no obligations to provide your real address, phone number, etc. Once you've selected an id and password and filled in the necessary details, click on 'Finish'. You're all set to go but don't forget to activate the account from the link in your email inbox first.

Add contacts

Once you're a part of the ICQ inner circle you'll be asked to add contacts from your email accounts. If you've skipped that step during registration, you can access it by clicking on the Menu button above and choosing the 'Add Contacts' option in the Contacts menu.

Chat directly with your AOL Instant Messenger friends in ICQ

Else you could use the shortcut F5 to go to the contacts feature immediately. If your contact has an ICQ account, you just have to fill in the nickname or ICQ id and he or she will be added to your chat buddy-list. This, however, is with the condition that your friend already has an ICQ id. For the rest, an account with AOL's messenger service (AIM) would do as well.



Text them from your desktop

Click on 'Add' and you'll receive a message informing you that the contact is now a part of your list of friends.

Send text messages

You can even add the phone number of your contact. Click on the 'Select contact type' arrow in your 'Add Contact' window and choose 'Phone Contact' from the drop down menu. The India code 91 should appear prefixed by default. Add the number of your contact in the blank tab next to it. This means that you can now send text messages through ICQ – but not yet in India because, as the message says, 'You currently cannot send SMS messages to this country or cellular network'. Hope they fix that bug quickly.

You can even send messages directly to phone numbers in six countries (including the US but not India) by clicking on the fourth icon in the list of tabs under the 'What's happening now' space above which says, well, 'SMS'.

Importing contacts

To add your friends from your favourite email service, click on the 'Import contacts' option in